

**SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK  
COUNTY OF NEW YORK**

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Index No.:

**WILFORD PERSON**

Date Purchased:

Plaintiff,

Date Filed:

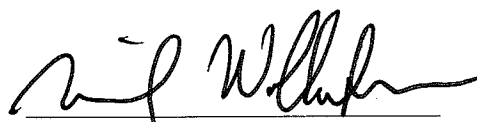
– against –

**SUMMONS****CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE  
DEPARTMENT, DETECTIVE WILDER SANCHEZ,  
POLICE OFFICER JOHN DOE and POLICE OFFICER  
JOHN ROE**Plaintiff designates New York County as  
the place of trial. The basis of venue is  
the action arose in New York County.

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Defendant(s).**TO THE ABOVE NAMED DEFENDANTS:**

**YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED** to answer the Verified Complaint in this action and to serve a copy of your answer, or, if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorney within 20 days after the service of the summons, exclusive of the day of service or within 30 days after the service is complete if this summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York; and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the notice set forth below and in the within Verified Complaint.

Date: New York, New York  
April 11, 2013**NEIL WOLLERSTEIN, ESQ.**Attorney for Plaintiff  
59 Maiden Lane, 17<sup>th</sup> Floor  
New York, NY 10038  
(212) 412-4705  
File No.: NW- 459

TO: MICHAEL A. CARDOZO, ESQ.  
Corporation Counsel of City Of New York  
100 Church Street  
New York, NY 10007

NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT  
1 Police Plaza  
New York, NY 10038

DETECTIVE WILDER SANCHEZ (Shield No. 7641)  
New York City Police Department  
1 Police Plaza  
New York, NY 10038

POLICE OFFICER JOHN DOE  
New York City Police Department  
1 Police Plaza  
New York, NY 10038

POLICE OFFICER JOHN ROE  
New York City Police Department  
1 Police Plaza  
New York, NY 10038

**SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK  
COUNTY OF NEW YORK**

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**WILFORD PERSON**

**INDEX NO.**

Plaintiff,

– against –

**CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE  
DEPARTMENT, DETECTIVE WILDER SANCHEZ,  
POLICE OFFICER JOHN DOE and POLICE OFFICER  
JOHN ROE**

**VERIFIED COMPLAINT**

Defendant(s).

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Plaintiff, by his attorney, **NEIL WOLLERSTEIN, ESQ.**, complaining of the defendants, respectfully shows to this Court and alleges the following upon information and belief:

**AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF  
PLAINTIFF WILFORD PERSON**

1. That at all times the Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** was and is a resident of Bronx County, State of New York.
2. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, the defendant, **CITY OF NEW YORK**, hereinafter referred to as “CITY”, was and still is a municipal corporation organized and existing under and by virtue of the laws of the State of New York.
3. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the defendant, **NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT**, hereinafter referred to as “NYPD”, was and is an agency of the defendant, CITY.
4. That on and prior to 9/14/12 and at all times hereinafter mentioned the defendant, **DETECTIVE WILDER SANCHEZ** (Shield No. 7641), hereinafter referred to as “SANCHEZ” was and is a police officer employed by the defendant NYPD, and at all times herein was acting in such capacity as the agent, servant and employee of the CITY and NYPD.

5. That on and prior to 9/14/12 and at all times hereinafter mentioned the defendant, POLICE OFFICER JOHN DOE, hereinafter referred to as "DOE" was and is a police officer employed by the defendant NYPD, and at all times herein was acting in such capacity as the agent, servant and employee of the CITY and NYPD.

6. That on and prior to 9/14/12 and at all times hereinafter mentioned the defendant, POLICE OFFICER JOHN ROE, hereinafter referred to as "ROE" was and is a police officer employed by the defendant NYPD, and at all times herein was acting in such capacity as the agent, servant and employee of the CITY and NYPD.

7. That within ninety (90) days after the causes of actions accrued herein, and more than thirty (30) days prior to the commencement of this action, the Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** caused the notice of claim, in writing, sworn to by and on behalf of the claimant, the Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** herein, containing the statement of the name and place of residence of the claimant by the street and number and his attorney, and describing the time when the particular claim and circumstances under which the damages and injuries were sustained, the cause thereof, and so far as practical, the nature and extent of the injuries to be personally served upon the defendant CITY, their agents, servants and/or employees at the Law Department,

8. This action was so commenced within one (1) year and ninety (90) days after said cause of action accrued herein, and for more than thirty (30) days prior to the commencement of this action, defendant CITY neglected, refused and failed to make an adjustment of said claim, and said claim remains unadjusted and unpaid, although plaintiff herein has requested and demanded that the same be paid and adjusted.

9. That the defendants requested an oral examination pursuant to General Municipal Law Section 50-H and said request was complied with.

10. That on or about 9/14/12, at approximately 1:00 p.m., the Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** while lawfully in the vicinity of 139<sup>th</sup> Street and Lenox Avenue, County of New York, City and State of New York, was without just cause, probable cause or provocation, maliciously, intentionally and falsely accused by CITY, NYPD, SANCHEZ, DOE and ROE of having committed the crime of Attempted Murder and other related charges.

11. That on or about 9/14/12, at approximately 1:00 p.m., the Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** was without just cause, probable cause or provocation, and with reckless, negligent and callous disregard for the truth, and without investigation, touched, grabbed, handcuffed, seized and arrested in an excessive manner and with excessive force by CITY, NYPD, SANCHEZ, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, and in particular, by SANCHEZ, DOE and ROE.

12. That on or about 9/14/12, and upon arresting the Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** and depriving him of his liberty, CITY, NYPD, SANCHEZ, DOE and ROE took the Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** to a police station in the County of New York and entered him on the records as under arrest.

13. That on or about 9/14/12, the CITY, NYPD, SANCHEZ, DOE and ROE further caused Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** to have his fingerprints and photographs to be taken without his consent and in accordance with police procedures for the arrest of criminals and held him on various criminal charges at various police stations, correctional facilities and at the Courthouse located at 100 Centre Street, County of New York, City and State of New York.

14. That on or about 9/14/12 Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** was aware of his arrest and confinement, he did not consent to his arrest or confinement, and said confinement, seizure, arrest and detention was without legal justification.

15. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD, SANCHEZ,

DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

16. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF**  
**PLAINTIFF WILFORD PERSON**

17. Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 16 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

18. That on or about 9/14/12, a criminal complaint was issued by the CITY, NYPD, SANCHEZ, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification.

19. That on or about 9/14/12 a criminal action against Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** was commenced by CITY, NYPD, SANCHEZ, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification.

20. That solely as a result of the aforesaid, the Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON'S** life was interfered with.

21. That the criminal action against Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** was continued for an extended period of time by defendants with malice and bad faith.

22. That solely as a result of the false arrest, assault, battery, false imprisonment and malicious prosecution of the Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON**, he was deprived of his liberty for an extended period of time and was subjected to scorn, ridicule, embarrassment and was degraded in the esteem of the community both personally and professionally.

23. That on or about 3/15/13, the criminal action against Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** was terminated favorably by dismissal.

24. That the actions of CITY, NYPD, SANCHEZ, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

25. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF**  
**PLAINTIFF WILFORD PERSON**

26. Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 25 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

27. That on or about 9/14/12, and while in the custody of the defendants in the County of New York, City of New York, the Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** was intentionally touched, pushed, assaulted, battered, violated, strip searched, humiliated and handcuffed by the CITY, NYPD, SANCHEZ, DOE and ROE, who were acting within the scope of their employment and authority in such a manner as to knowingly cause injury to plaintiff.

28. That on or about 9/14/12 CITY, NYPD, SANCHEZ, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and employees, acting as agents and on behalf of the CITY, NYPD, SANCHEZ, DOE and ROE, within the scope of their employment, did intentionally, willfully and maliciously assault and batter the Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** in that they have the real or apparent ability to cause imminent harmful and/or offensive bodily contact and intentionally did a violent and/or menacing act which threatened such contact to the Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** and their act caused apprehension of such contact in the plaintiff, and in a hostile and/or offensive manner touched and

beat the plaintiff and/or offensive bodily contact to the Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** and caused such battery in and about his head, neck, back, body and limbs.

29. That by reason of the aforesaid intentional assault and battery which was committed in an excessive manner and with excessive force and without legal justification or privilege by the defendants, their agents, servants and employees, who were acting within the scope of their employment and authority and without any probable or reasonable cause, Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** suffered great and permanent bodily injury in and about his head, neck, back, body and limbs and was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled, and suffered conscious pain and suffering, and that he was otherwise damaged.

30. That as a result of the aforesaid assault and battery the Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** was caused to sustain serious, severe, painful and permanent bodily injuries so that he was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled and so remains and was and will be compelled to seek medical aid and attention and incur expenses for same in an endeavor to cure himself of his said injuries and he was and will be prevented from attending his usual occupation and duties.

31. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD, SANCHEZ, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

32. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF**  
**PLAINTIFF WILFORD PERSON**

33. Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 32 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth



at length herein.

34. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the aforesaid false arrest, assault, battery, false imprisonment and malicious prosecution was caused solely as a result of the negligence of CITY, NYPD, SANCHEZ, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees.

35. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD, SANCHEZ, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

36. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF**  
**PLAINTIFF WILFORD PERSON**

37. Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1-36 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

38. That the CITY, NYPD, their agents, servants and employees failed to adequately and properly train, supervise, discipline or in any other way control the behavior of their personnel and in particular defendants SANCHEZ, DOE and ROE, and in their hiring practices in the exercise of their functions in that they had a reckless lack of cautious regard for the rights of the public, including Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** and exhibited a lack of that degree of due care which prudent and reasonable individuals would show in executing the duties of the defendants.

39. Defendants CITY and NYPD have grossly failed to train and adequately supervise its police officers and employees in the fundamental law of arrest, search and seizure especially when its police officers and employees are not in possession of a court authorized arrest warrant and where an

individual, especially as here, has not committed a crime and has not resisted arrest, that its police officers and employees should only use reasonable force to effectuate an arrest and the arrest should be based on probable cause.

40. Defendant CITY was negligent by failing to implement a policy and instruct police officers who, absent the consent of Plaintiff (or similarly situated individuals) or without the possession of a court authorized arrest warrant or search warrant, said police officers of the CITY and NYPD are not to arrest individuals such as Plaintiff herein where probable cause is lacking and the use of force should only be reasonable when an individual resists arrest and should not be used where an individual is not resisting arrest.

41. Defendant CITY is negligent due to its failure to implement a policy or actively enforce the law if any of the following are lacking: i) probable cause must be present before an individual such as the Plaintiff herein can be arrested; ii) excessive force cannot be used against an individual who does not physically resist arrest; iii) an individual who sustains physical injury at the hands of the police during the arrest process should receive prompt medical attention.

42. The foregoing acts, omissions, and systemic failures are customs and policies of the CITY and NYPD which caused the police officers herein to falsely arrest, falsely imprison, seize, illegally search, commit an assault and battery on Plaintiff, maliciously prosecute and deny him prompt medical attention under the belief that they would suffer no disciplinary actions for their failure to take proper or prudent steps in this case.

43. Defendant CITY was also negligent in that prior to and at the time of the acts complained of herein, due to the prior history of the Police Officer Defendants named herein, knew or should have known of the bad disposition of said defendants, or at the very least had knowledge of facts that would put a reasonably prudent employer on inquiry concerning their bad disposition and

the fact that defendant police officers were not suitable to be hired and employed by the CITY and that due to their lack of training, these officers should have had adequate supervision so that they would not arrest innocent individuals nor use excessive force during the arrest process.

44. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD and all defendants herein as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

45. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF**  
**PLAINTIFF WILFORD PERSON**

46. Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1-45 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

47. In arresting Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON**, police officers including but not limited to SANCHEZ, DOE and ROE, acting in their capacity as agents, servants and employees of CITY and NYPD, were motivated by an ulterior purpose to do harm, without justification or economic or social excuse.

48. In arresting Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON**, police officers including but not limited to SANCHEZ, DOE and ROE, acting in their capacity as agents, servants and employees of CITY and NYPD, sought either a detriment to Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** or a collateral advantage to the CITY and NYPD that is outside the legitimate ends of effectuating an arrest.

49. As a result of the abuse of process by defendants herein, Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** sustained multiple injuries including but not limited to loss of liberty, emotional distress,

humiliation, loss of enjoyment of life, and fear and intimidation for his safety.

50. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF**  
**PLAINTIFF WILFORD PERSON**

51. Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 - 50 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

52. At all times mentioned herein, defendants CITY, NYPD and NYPD police officers SANCHEZ, DOE and ROE were acting under color of law, to wit: the statutes, ordinances and regulations, policies and customs and usage of the State of New York and/or City of New York.

53. Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** is and at all times relevant herein, a citizen of the United States and a resident of New York County in the State of New York and brings this cause of action pursuant to 42 United States Code, Section 1983 and 42 United States Code, Section 1988.

54. That on or about 9/14/12, defendants CITY, NYPD, SANCHEZ, DOE and ROE without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification and while effectuating the seizure of plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON**, did search, seize, assault and commit a battery and grab the Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** without a court authorized arrest warrant or search warrant and defendants did physically seize Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** during the arrest process in an unlawful and excessive manner. Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** was falsely arrested, unlawfully imprisoned and as a result of defendants' conduct maliciously prosecuted without the defendants possessing probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification to do so.

55. The above actions of defendants CITY, NYPD, SANCHEZ, DOE and ROE resulted

in Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** being deprived of the following rights under the United States Constitution: a) Freedom from assault to his person; b) Freedom from battery to his person; c) Freedom from illegal search and seizure; d) Freedom from false arrest; e) Freedom from malicious prosecution; and f) Freedom from the use of excessive force during the arrest process.

56. In addition to the above, defendants CITY and NYPD have as a matter of policy, custom and practice and with deliberate indifference failed to adequately train, supervise, discipline, sanction or otherwise direct its police officers, including the officers involved in this case and any and all unnamed officers involved in the unlawful seizure and arrest of plaintiff, regarding the protection of the constitutional rights of citizens.

57. Defendants CITY, NYPD, SANCHEZ, DOE and ROE subjected Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** to such deprivation in a malicious, reckless, deliberate, intentional, grossly negligent and with a callous disregard of Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON**'s rights and with deliberate indifference to those rights under the Fourth, Fifth, Sixth, Fourteenth and all other related Amendments to the United States Constitution.

58. The direct and proximate result of the defendants CITY, NYPD, SANCHEZ, DOE and ROE acts are that Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** has suffered severe and permanent injuries, loss of liberty and companionship, forced to endure pain and suffering, emotional distress and severe and significant damage to standing and reputation in the community.

59. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**WHEREFORE**, the Plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON** demands judgment against the defendants on the First Cause of Action through the Seventh Cause of Action in a sum that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state for each cause of action, all together with attorney's fees, punitive damages and the costs and disbursements of this action.

Dated: New York, New York  
April 11, 2013

Yours, etc.,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Neil Wollerstein', written over a horizontal line.

**NEIL WOLLERSTEIN, ESQ.**

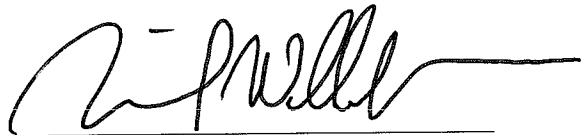
Attorney for Plaintiff  
59 Maiden Lane, 17<sup>th</sup> Floor  
New York, NY 10038  
(212) 412-4705  
File No.: NW-459

**ATTORNEY VERIFICATION**

**NEIL WOLLERSTEIN**, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the courts of the State of New York affirms the following to be true pursuant to CPLR 2106 and under the penalties of perjury:

1. The undersigned, an attorney admitted to practice in the Courts of the State of New York states that he is retained on behalf of plaintiff **WILFORD PERSON**.
2. That affirmant has read the foregoing **SUMMONS and COMPLAINT** and knows the contents thereof; that the same is true to affirmant's own knowledge except as to the matters therein stated to be alleged on information and belief; and that as to those matters affirmant believes them to be true.
3. Your affirmant further says that the reason this verification is made by affirmant and not the plaintiff is that the plaintiff is not within the County of New York where affirmant maintains his office.

Dated: New York, New York  
April 11, 2013

  
\_\_\_\_\_  
**NEIL WOLLERSTEIN**

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK  
COUNTY OF NEW YORK

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**WILFORD PERSON**

Plaintiff,

— against —

**CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT,  
DETECTIVE WILDER SANCHEZ, POLICE OFFICER JOHN DOE  
and POLICE OFFICER JOHN ROE**

Defendant(s).

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**SUMMONS AND COMPLAINT**

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**NEIL WOLLERSTEIN, ESQ.**

Attorney for Plaintiff  
59 Maiden Lane, 17<sup>th</sup> Floor  
New York, NY 10038  
Tel: (212) 412-4705  
Fax: (917) 522-9703  
File No.: NW-459